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and Michael Weiss



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A Hoarse of a Different Color (Plautus, *Poen.* 778 *rāviō*)

A .: *negasne apud te esse aurum nec servom meum?*
L .: *nego; et negando, si quid refert, ravio.* (Plaut., *Poen.* – ; *ia*)

rauio *A*, *Turnebi schedae* (Adv. .), cf. P.F. . L r/a·uio (o *ex* a) *B* auio *CD* arguā (*i.e.* arguam) *Geppert* raucīā (*i.e.* rauciam) *Schueth* rauiero *Mueller, Havet* aruio *Lindsay* cf. Sidon. Apoll. *rāvus, rāvulus* 'raucus' *Marx*

1. When the *adulescens* Agorastocles, pursuing his interrogation, pointedly asks the *leno* Lycus, "Do you deny having my money and my slave at your house?" (Plaut., *Poen.*), Lycus retorts (following the version of *Poen.* given above, and with the modern understanding of the absolute hapax *rāviō* 'I am hoarse, I talk myself hoarse', cf. *OLD* s.v.), "I *do* deny it—and, if it makes any di erence, I'm going hoarse in denying it!" This seems straightforward enough, and is eminently Plautine; note the characteristic line-ending "retort alliteration" in ***refert ravio***. Yet there is a serious linguistic problem here: the first syllable of "*ravio*" must scan long (thus *rāviō*), even though the corresponding abstract *ravis* (f.) 'hoarseness', securely attested twice in Plautus, and in contexts broadly similar to that of *Poen.* , scans both times (likewise in iambic senarii) with short first syllable:

ubi si quid poscam, usque ad ravim poscam prius
quam quicquam detur (*Aul.* –)
"If I were to ask for anything there, I'd ask myself hoarse before anything was given away."

"*ravim* dicebant pro raucitate, unde et verbum *ravio, ravias*."

Geppert (:): "a m. pr. auia, deinde rauia", similarly Schueth : n. .

So printed by Ritschl , Leo, Ernout, Maurach (:)—though not by Lindsay (*OCT*), more on which below.

Translations here by de Melo (a, b). Otherwise, translations are my own.

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expurigabo hercle omnia ad raucam ravim (*Cist.*)
"I'll apologize for everything till I'm completely hoarse."

Note further that in the second of these, the alliterating phrase ***raucam ravim*** (again line-ending) is essentially a ***figura etymologica*** (i.e., *raucus* < **rău̯i-ko-*, cf. *răvi-* in *ravis*).

Such discrepancies in vowel length or syllable weight were hardly unnoticed even by the ancients: as Cicero tells us (in one of several such passages), *in versu quidem theatra tota exclamant, si fuit una syllaba aut brevior aut longior*. Predictably, then, and as the above apparatus indicates, the problem with *rāviō* is widely recognized by editors, whence (especially) a series of emendations, to be assessed below. In contrast, and despite the tendency in modern editions to maintain *rāviō*, this stark and puzzling di erence in vocalism is almost entirely ignored otherwise, including in the standard Latin handbooks and lexica, except occasionally to be dismissed.

Indeed, the di culty has been rendered even more acute by the modern understanding of the historical background of *ravis* and its pendant adjective *ravus* 'hoarse' (P.F. . L: "*rava vox* rauca et parum liquida, proxime canum latratum sonans"). As discussed by Schindler in a classic paper (:), the *o*-stem adjective *ravus* is the basis of the *i*-stem substantivization *ravis*, one of a series of Latin examples of a widespread process reconstructable for Proto-Indo-European itself, and by now much discussed. For its part, *ravus* 'hoarse'—the etymologically basic *forme de fondation*—is interpretable as a "τομός form" **h₃rou̯H-ó-* 'roaring' (to **h₃reu̯H-* 'roar'; Ved. *ruváti*, Gk. *ὠρύομαι*, etc.), with the Latin *a*-vocalism resulting regularly from "Thurneysen-Havet's Law" (Vine : , cf. de Vaan : s.v. *ravus*).

2. For a recalcitrant textual problem of this kind, it comes as no surprise that the solution of choice has been emendation.

2.1. The proposals put forward before the results of *A* (the famous "Ambrosian palimpsest", cf. Studemund) were widely known are of limited value, exclusively based as they are on the Palatine tradition; and they are deficient even when assessed on their own terms, as emerges from the following survey.

2.1.1. On the basis of *B auia/rauia* (cf. the apparatus above), Geppert (:) conjectured *arguā*, i.e. *arguam*. This is not especially appealing paleographically, and turns out to have no support from *A*: cf. Studemund's pointed comment (ad loc.)

Another instance of *ad ravim* may occur at Caecil. – Ribb. (cf. Festus . L), in a fragmentary context.

Orat. . . See Fontaine a: for other testimony of this sort.

See, e.g., de Vaan : s.v. *ravus*, following Schrijver (:): "Lat. *rāvīre* (with long *-ā-*) cannot be taken seriously: it occurs only once, in a corrupt passage."

Another item with a similar profile in Latin (likewise treated by Schindler): *tor(r)um* 'torridum, aridum' (Fest. . L, P.F. . L) → (concretized abstract) *torris* 'firebrand' [Verg.+]. On the pattern, see Nussbaum : , and more recently Rau : and Hackstein : f. (all with further references).

I.e., *B*, *C*, *D*, and *T* (the "codex Turnebi", on which see recently Fontaine b).

"tertia ab exitu littera nullo modo G fuit." Nor is *arguam* 'I will assert/a rm/declare (it)' successful in other respects. It lacks point, in context, after *si quid refert*, and removes the characteristic alliterating pattern; moreover, the "absolute" use of *arguo* (with elliptical complement) is nearly nonexistent (see Lodge and *TLL* s.v.). Nevertheless, the future tense (in the sequence *nego* [pres.], *et negando* . . . [fut.]), while not strictly necessary, has seemed attractive, to judge from other emendations with future or future perfect, as we will see.

2.1.2. In a delightful display of *odium philologicum*, Schueth countered Geppert's approach: "Pulcerrimam codicum scripturam [scil. *rauia B*, taken as *rauiā* = *rauiam*; BV] misere ut solet . . . pervertit Geppertus" (:). He went on to observe that *răviam* (cf. *răvim*) is metrically impossible, whence his own conjecture *rauciam*. In evaluating this proposal, we may begin by admitting that a verb *rauciō* 'be hoarse' (← adj. *raucus* 'hoarse') is theoretically possible (cf. the denominative type *saeviō* 'be cruel' ← *saevus* 'cruel', etc.); but such a verb (absent as a simplex from *OLD*) is virtually unattested otherwise. Priscian (II. . K) claims the existence of a perfect *rausī* beside present *rauciō*, in a discussion of the pattern seen in *sarciō*/*sarsī* 'mend', *farciō*/*farsī* 'stu ', *fulciō*/*fulsī* 'support'; and a form "*raucit*", glossed *βραγχιᾷ* 'is hoarse', is attested in the so-called "Philoxenus" Glossary (*CGL* II. .). For the first: a perfect stem *raus-* probably does exist (more on which below, § . .); but whereas the pattern *sarciō*/*sarsī* (et sim.) is phonologically regular, the *s*-perfect of a verb *rauciō* (th conj.) could only have been †*rauxī*. The only *textual* attestation of a verbal *rauc-* form is *inraucuerit* (codd., vs. *inrauserit* Prisc.) at Cic. *de Orat.* . ; but this points to *(in)rauceō* or *(in)raucēscō* (so correctly *OLD*, s.v. "? *irraucēscō*")—a regular "denominative stative/inceptive" to *raucus*, of the type *albus* 'white' → *albeō*/*albēscō* 'be(come) white'—and not †*(in)rauciō*. Thus, as already seen by Neue-Wagener, Priscian's "*rauciō*" probably has no real existence, and is merely back-formed from the perfect stem *raus-* (with support from the *rauc-* of *raucus*) after the type *sarciō*/*sarsī* etc., to help support his point about this pattern. As for the gloss form *raucit*: the highly corrupt "Philoxenus" Glossary (late th c. AD, surviving in a single th-c. MS) was compiled from many sources—including passages from earlier grammarians. Thus *raucit* may in fact derive from Priscian (or a similar source). At best, then, one might propose to read *rauceō*, although this verb is never actually attested as an infectum.

Geppert's edition ("cum variis lectionibus codicis Ambrosiani") in fact makes limited reference to *A* (cf. further Geppert), but not for this passage.

In Plautus, only *Men.* comes close; but here the clipped question *Quis arguit?* (in a rapid-fire dialogue with five speaker-changes in a single line) o ers no real support for "elliptical *arguo*".

On the stop-loss pattern *RTs* > *Rs*, see Weiss : f.

Havet (:) argues against *inrauserit*, on the basis of the clausula.

: , cf. *TLL* VII . . . f. (s.v. *irraucio*); similarly Mignot (: f.).

On the "Philoxenus" Glossary, see Lindsay (with discussion of portions derived from Charisius and other grammarians).

2.2. Emendations suggested around the time of Studemund's publication of *A* and thereafter are equally unsuccessful.

2.2.1. Independently, as it seems, both Mueller (:) and Havet (:) proposed to read *răvierō* (fut. perf.). On the desirability of a future form of some kind here (cf. § . . above, ad fin.), Mueller was quite explicit ("futuro opus est"); and while this suggestion is superficially attractive, it is ultimately problematic. Leaving aside the question of paleography (→ is not impossible, if perhaps not terribly plausible), there are two morphological di culties worth noting. This proposal appears to assume that a th-conjugation denominative *răviō*, with perfect *răvii*, was formed on the basis of either *răvus* or *răvis*, and this is again technically possible. But one issue that must be faced is that according to Festus, as we have seen (n.), the verb *raviō* belongs to the st conjugation, not the th (a point to which we return below). More serious is the fact that "shortened" th-conjugation perfects like *ravĭerō* (i.e., with both *v*-loss and "vocalis ante vocalem" shortening, as opposed to *ravīverō* or *ravīerō*) have a slim profile before (approximately) Accius. Thus in Plautus, comparable sg. fut. perf. forms regularly have *-īverō*, just as the regular form of perfect subjunctives is *-īverim* etc., and indeed similar forms are the norm throughout the *v*-perfect generally. Apart from the lone and highly uncertain form *audĭerint* (*Cas.* , in a canticum, where *A* is not available and *P* is mutilated; see Questa : f. ad loc. [= his]), one finds only *intrōĭeris Mer.* , *<intrō> ĭeris Truc.* , *intrōĭerit Trin.* (all *ia*). Thus one cannot lightly posit a *ravĭerō*, which presents its own problems. At best, one might consider *ravus erō*, if not for the paleographical di culties with this, too, and the weak attestation of *ravus*, known only from Festus (§ above).

2.2.2. The di culty with a transmitted "*rāviō*" was apparent to Lindsay, who queried, citing Plautus' *răvim*: "Should we read 'rāviō' or 'arviō' in Poen. (Sen.)?", together with the observation that "[a]lliteration favours ra-" (:). Lindsay's alternative "*arviō*" was presumably guided by the fact that Studemund (ad loc.) had given not only the primary reading in *A*, but also , with notation identifying this as a lectio "minus probabilis". Indeed, in his *OCT* text (v. ,), Lindsay had in fact printed *aruio*, identifying this in his apparatus as a "forma plebeia"; hence the *OLD* entry "? *aruiō* 'colloqu. form of '". Such a claim, however, has no linguistic basis: no comparable alternation is citable—there is, for example, no †*arpiō* as

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For an *o*-stem basis, cf. *saeviō*, perf. *saevīī* (§ . . above); similarly for *i*-stems: e.g. *sitis* 'thirst' → *sitiō* 'be thirsty' (perf. *sitiī*).

On such shortened perfects, see Neue-Wagener : . (fut. perf.: .) and Ernout : . *expolīverō Poen.* , *audīverō Ep.* , *Per.* , *condīverō Ps.* , *muttīverō Mil.* , *īverō Cap.* , *St.* . E.g. for *audiō*: *audīverim Am.* , *-īverīs Mil.* , *Trin.* , *-īverit Cas.* , etc.

E.g. sg. perf.: *audīvī* ×, *sepelīvī Mos.* , *cōnstabilīvī Cap.* , *concustōdīvī Aul.* , *admūnīvī Cist.* , *expedīvī Cap.* , etc. (and not †*audiī*, †*sepeliī*, etc.).

More specifically: Studemund's notation indicates that the bottoms of the first two letters are damaged, which (in the lettering style of *A*) renders and di cult to distinguish.

a "colloquial form" of *rapiō*, or any other such form—and in general, as Leumann has noted, such "Interversion" in Latin is otherwise "kaum zu beobachten" (:).

Under the assumption that Lindsay's ⟨aruio⟩ reflects trisyllabic /arwiō/, a variant of this approach has been proposed by Richlin, who, while adopting Lindsay's textual suggestion, interprets it as quadrisyllabic /ărŭiō/: she translates the form as "I'll howl" (:), and writes: "surely it is onomatopoeia, reproducing the noise the Wolf would naturally make" (:), the reference being to a lupine howl of the sort "aROOO!", emitted by the character Lycus (= Λύκος 'Wolf'). To be sure, there is something to be said for the phonetic similarity between a supposed howl of this kind and Lat. *ululāre*, the *vox propria* for the howling of wolves. Nevertheless, apart from the unlikely appeal to an otherwise unattested onomatopoeic verb (and that for a language that is rich in such verbs), I find this unconvincing for reasons having to do with the context itself. The expression here clearly points to "hoarseness", rather than "howling": in addition to the semantically similar passages with *ad ravim* (§), note further the striking phraseological parallel between ***negando*** *...* ***ravio*** (in our passage) and *rogit**ando** sum **raucus** factus* (*Ep.*).

2.2.3. The lure of emendation is hard to resist. If one were to attempt a new conjecture at least as plausible as those surveyed above, a useful starting point would be the perfect stem *raus-*, already mentioned (§ . .) and securely attested in a hexameter verse of Lucilius (M = Kr, Warm), cited by Priscian (II. . K) to illustrate parallel perfectum patterns *rausi/rausum* ∼ *sensi/sensum*:

rausuro tragicus qui carmina perdit Oreste
"a tragic actor who butchers his part because his Orestes will be hoarse"

As seen by Meiser (: , cf. n), the perfect stem *raus-* is best explained via a nd-conjugation **raudeō*, itself regularly derived from a **ravido-*; cf. the parallel pattern in *avidus* 'eager' → *audeō* 'dare' (perf. *aus-*), *āridus* 'dry' → *ārdeō* 'burn' (perf. *ārs-*). Given, then, (**ravidus* →) **raudeō/rausī*, one could consider, as a solution to the problem posed by transmitted *rāviō*, an emendation *raudeō*, or even (if a future

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Superficially similar, but ultimately not comparable, are loanwords like (τραπεζίτης →) *tarpezīta* 'banker' (*Cur.* +), (κροκωτός 'sa ron-colored' →) *corcōtāriī* 'sa ron-dyers' (*Aul.* , vs. *crocōtulam* 'sa ron-colored dress', *Ep.*), *phyrygiō* 'embroiderer' (*Aul.* , vs. *phrȳgiō Men.* +); and the variant *arcessō* beside more original *accersō* 'fetch' [both Plt.+] results from a complex rearrangement (Nussbaum :§ . . .) that likewise o ers no support for "*aruiō*" as a "forma plebeia".

Warm thanks to my colleague Amy Richlin for helpful comments on this point and some others connected with this paper.

E.g. Verg. *G.* . , not to mention the testimony of treatises on *voces animalium* (see e.g. Finch : , Benediktson : ,).

Such essential unities inherent in the entire set of "hoarseness" passages in Plautus were already seen by Egli (– :II.).

Thus correct the persistent presumption, based on Priscian (§ . .), that *raus-* is the perfect stem belonging to a verb *raciō* (so e.g. Krenkel ad loc.). The form *rauidus* (*CGL* IV. . , glossing *rabola*) probably does not belong here, as it may be a false spelling for *rabidus* (Havet : f.).

perfect should be judged semantically preferable, cf. §§ . . and . .) fut. perf. *rauserō* (though this would be paleographically more di cult). If, moreover, one considers the possibility of a fientive present (**ravidus* ∼) *ravefiō* 'I become hoarse' (cf. *sum raucus factus*, § . .), of the type *calefiō* 'become warm' beside *calidus* 'warm', this allows for the further possibility of a syncopated *raufiō* (cf. *calfiō*/*calfaciō*, *olfaciō* 'smell', etc.). Certainly in terms of paleography, this may be the most attractive conjecture of all: the distance from to is very small, especially if one considers the "narrow F" (almost like "I") that is characteristic of the lettering of *A* (cf. Studemund's samples, :xxvi), or else the possibility of cursive F in the archetype (or at some stage prior to *A*).

2.3. In the end, however, all of these attempts at emendation must be judged failures. Both branches of the manuscript tradition point to "*ravio*" (metrically *rāviō*), and furthermore a verb "*ravio*" (in the appropriate meaning) is actually attested in Festus (n.). This is the reading that should be retained (as most modern editors agree), and this is the form that must then be provided with an explanation.

3. We conclude our survey of previous approaches to the problem by recalling the one solution o ered without recourse to emendation (see once more the apparatus at top), due to Friedrich Marx (: , ad Lucil. M): he suggested that the adjective "*ravus*" (in Festus' *rava vox*, §) is actually *rāvus*, and is the same word as Lat. *rāvus* 'tawny, grey', since Sidonius Apollinaris (th c. AD) uses an adjective *rāvus* (so scanned; also diminutive *rāvulus*) to mean both 'grey' and 'hoarse'. This usage, according to Marx, can itself be justified by comparison with Gk. *φαιός* '(dark) grey, blackish', "nam *φαιός* similiter apud Graecos usurpatur et de colore et de voce". Plautus' *rāviō*, says Marx, further supports *rāvus*, even though (as Marx admits) the abstract *răvis* clearly has *ă*, for which Marx o ers no explanation.

This approach is unacceptable for a number of reasons, and we may begin with the last point, concerning *răvis*. As we have seen (**1.**), the modern understanding of the morphology of "*ravus*" (Festus) beside *răvis* calls for a thematic *răvus*, with etymological **ŏ* > /ă/ by Thurneysen-Havet's Law and a basis in a PIE "*τομός* form"—all of this being phonologically, morphologically, and etymologically straightforward. In contrast, to consider Marx's perspective on the matter: there is no plausible etymological

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For line-final *ravefiō*, cf. line-final *calefieri Ep.* , *calefierent Per.* .

For attestations, see Christiansen and Holland : . Earlier evidence for forms of this kind is uncertain. The name *Rāvola* (line-initial at Juv. .) was interpreted by the scholiast (ad loc., Wessner :) "etymologically" ("a facto etymologiam nominis sumpsit poeta"), and this has sometimes been taken, despite the long vowel, to refer to *ravus* 'hoarse' (e.g. Green :); but the context does not allow for certainty. Entirely unusable is the fragmentary sequence …*t ravi*… (Lucil. M = Kr, Warm, from Fest. . L): although some reconstructions of the passage assume *rāvi*… as part of a hexameter line (so Krenkel, based on Cichorius : f.), the metrical context is in fact unclear; the hexameter interpretation is explicitly rejected, perhaps rightly, by Havet (:).

source for a *rāvus* 'hoarse' (with *ā*), and no known shortening process (whether purely phonological or as part of a morphological derivation) that could account for the development of a *răvis* 'hoarseness' from an original *rāvus* 'hoarse'. Moreover, the rare metaphorical use of Gk. *φαιός* with reference to the voice (Aristotle +) means 'harsh' (in various ways), but not 'hoarse'; the latter concept is expressed in Greek by a well-attested series of forms based on a root *βραγχ-* (adj. *βραγχός*, *βραγχώδης*, *βραγχαλέος*, nouns *βράγχος*, *βράγχη*, *βραγχεία*, verbs *βραγχάω*, *βραγχιάω*, etc.). It can be added that Lat. *rāvus* 'grey' (cognate with Eng. *grey* and its Germanic congeners) has initial **g^h-*—cf. Plt. (*g*)*rāvāstellus* 'old-timer, greybeard' (*Ep.*), with a trace of manuscript variation pointing to this source; this contrasts with the consistent *r-* in *ravus, ravio* (Festus), *răvim, rāviō* (Plt.), *raucus* (Plt.+).

With a more benevolent attitude to Marx's suggestion, we might operate not with a real linguistic relationship between *rāviō* and *rāvus* 'grey', but rather with the idea of a pun or pun-based contamination (see recently Fontaine a passim). For example, *răvis* 'hoarseness' × *rāvus* 'grey' → "*rāviō*" 'I'm (turning) hoarse/grey', i.e. 'I'm talking myself grey = I'll be talking until I'm old and grey'. But this, too, is ultimately unsatisfying, as it lacks point in context, and fails to match the other Plautine "pure hoarseness" contexts (cf. again § . .). Finally (and, I think, fatally) for this sort of approach, Fontaine himself has found that "Plautus generally does *not* pun on vowels or syllables of di ering length" (a:). As for Marx's comparison to Gk. *φαιός*: direct influence from this feature of Greek philosophical writing is highly improbable. At best, one can point to the usage of Lat. *fuscus* 'dark' with reference to the voice, and perhaps even to hoarseness. But there is no evidence for associations between *rāvus* 'grey' (mostly used with reference to eyes; Mignot :) and vocal behavior.

It is important to consider, then, how best to interpret the odd scansion *rāvus, rāvulus* 'hoarse' in the poetry of Sidonius—a strict technician, with good control of classical prosody and a penchant for archaism. Havet's suggestion (:) that this is merely a mistake on the part of Sidonius is not credible. Rather, as Maurach has plausibly suggested (: , similarly :), this metrical behavior raises the suspicion that Sidonius was basing himself on something real and something old—quite possibly Plautus' *rāviō* itself. To explicate this idea more concretely: Sidonius could have interpreted *rāviō* as a denominative of the *saeviō* ← *saevus* type (§ . .), whence a back-formed adjective *rāvus* 'hoarse', perhaps supported by the adjective in that meaning spelled ⟨rava⟩ (masc. "*ravus*") in Festus (if Sidonius knew about this form, though for him with indeterminate vowel length). The conclusion to be drawn from this material, then, is that *rāvus, rāvulus* 'hoarse' in Sidonius may well provide an additional argument favoring the existence of a real "*rāviō*" (the probable reading of *A* at *Poen.*

Note, for example, Cic. *N.D.* . (*fuscus* among *vocis genera permulta*) and Pliny *N.H.* . (degeneration of the voice from *candida* to *fusca*, cf. Quintil. . . on *natura vocis*, contrasting *candida* and *fusca*).

For helpful discussion of some of the material in this paragraph, I am indebted to my colleague Shane Butler, to whom I owe the references in the preceding footnote.

), which, given the linguistic anomaly of its long root vowel (vis-à-vis the abstract *răvis*), urgently requires an explanation.

4. In order to approach an explanation for *rāviō* (as a real form), we may begin by considering the sources of *-iō* verbs in Latin. Broadly speaking, these are of two types: "primary" (i.e., directly based on a verbal root, e.g. *veniō* 'come' < PIE **ǵʷm̥-i̯e/o-*, cf. Gk. *βαίνω* 'id.' [*LIV* s.v. **ǵʷem-*]), and "denominative" (i.e., based on a noun or adjective stem; further details below, but cf. already above, passim, on the patterns *saevus* → *saeviō* and *sitis* → *sitiō*).

4.1. The only bona fide *i̯e/o*-present in Latin with lengthened-grade root vocalism is *sōpiō* 'put to sleep'; yet this is a special case (note the causative meaning), with its own explanation. However Lat. *sōpiō* is to be accounted for, it does not o er any purchase for explaining *rāviō*. Thus, an account of *rāviō* as a primary verb would require one to posit an anomalous and in any event hitherto unattested derivational type, and this is clearly unacceptable. The necessary conclusion, then, is that *rāviō* 'I am hoarse' (Plt.)—somehow related to *ravis* 'hoarseness' (Plt.) and *ravus* 'hoarse' (Festus)—is best interpreted as denominative.

4.2. Leaving aside, for the moment, one marginal subtype to be mentioned later, there are three denominative subtypes of immediate relevance for such a problem:

(a) *i*-stem noun or adjective → *-iō, -īre* verb (e.g. *siti-* 'thirst' → *sitīre* 'be thirsty')
(b) *o*-stem noun or adjective → *-iō, -īre* verb (e.g. *servo-* 'slave' → *servīre* 'be a slave'; *saevo-* 'cruel' → *saevīre* 'be cruel')
(c) *io*-stem noun or adjective → *-iō, -iāre* verb (e.g. *nūntio-* 'message, messenger' → *nūntiāre* 'announce')

Thus, corresponding to each of these, we can posit the following three hypothetical source forms:

(a′) *i*-stem **rāvi-* (→ *rāviō*, *rāvīre*)
(b′) *o*-stem **rāvo-* (→ *rāviō*, *rāvīre*)
(c′) *io*-stem **rāvio-* (→ *rāviō*, *rāviāre*)

To restate the problem in formal terms: "*răvo-*, *răvi-* ∼ *rāvX-*; *rāvX-* → *rāviō*"; i.e., in plain language: What sort of *ā*-formation ("*rāvX-*") could have stood beside existing *răvo-* and/or *răvi*, with this *ā*-formation then serving as the basis for a denominative *rāviō*?

For basic information on Latin *-iō* verbs, see Weiss : f.; recently *in extenso* Martzlo .
The matter is notoriously controversial; extensive discussion, with earlier references, in Vine .

4.3. When the problem is viewed in this light, two well-known forms immediately suggest themselves as comparanda:

(a) Ital. **sākri-*: Lat. *porcī sācrēs* (Plt.) ← **sakro-* 'holy' (Lat. *sacer* [For. Inscr.])

(b) Ital. **ākri-*: Lat. *ācer* 'sharp' ← **akro-* (< **h₂eḱ-ro-*: Gk. *ἄκρος* 'topmost', OCS *ostrŭ* 'sharp' etc.; cf. **h₂óḱ-ri-*/**h₂éḱ-ri-* in Lat. *ocris*, U. **ukar**/*ocar* 'hilltop, Lat. *acerbus* 'harsh')

As is well known, this type of morphological pattern ("[*o*-stem] *a* → [*i*-stem] *ā*") embodies a subtype of the derivational process called "vr̥ddhi" (Skt. = 'increase'), differing in two main respects from more familiar PIE-level vr̥ddhi processes: first, these latter tend to show di erent patterns of root-vocalism "increase" (typically "∅ → *e*" or "*e* → *ē*"); and secondly, it is the derived form that is most commonly an *o*-stem.

The "*a* → *ā* vr̥ddhi" seen in Italic forms like **sākri-* and **ākri-* is not fully understood. As it happens, however, significant progress in this area—as in so many others connected with PIE nominal derivation—has been made by none other than Alan Nussbaum, in several recent studies (in particular a, b). The essential points, for our purposes, are the following. First, Nussbaum establishes "*i*-vr̥ddhi" (attested in Indo-Iranian, Germanic, and Italic, beside the more common "*o*-vr̥ddhi") as an IE process. Secondly, he identifies two subtypes, namely (i) "genitival" *i*-vr̥ddhi, as in *sacrum/sacra* 'rite(s)' → *sācri-* 'of/belonging to the rites', i.e. 'for sacrificing', and (ii) "adjectival" *i*-vr̥ddhi, as in (weak stem **h₂éḱ-ri-* 'point' >) **h₂áḱ-ri-* → **h₂āḱ-ri-* 'point-like, sharp' (Lat. *ācer*). Note further that in Nussbaum's formulation of the latter, the source of the *i*-stem derivative is itself an *i*-stem (as opposed to the more traditional version given above, with *o*-stem source).

There is most likely more than one vr̥ddhi-scenario that could be entertained for explaining the background of *rāviō*. But the simplest assumption (in view of the "*a* → *ā*-vr̥ddhi" forms known so far) might be that the old thematic adjective *răvus* 'hoarse' (attested only in Festus) was replaced by two di erent formations, both of them based on its substantival *i*-stem derivative *răvis* 'hoarseness' : (i) an adjective **rāvi-* 'hoarse'

The length in **sākri-* is usually taken to be guaranteed metrically at *Rud.* (but see Fortson : n. for a more skeptical view of the matter); the same form probably appears in Lat. ⟨sacrem⟩ (Fest. . L, sometimes attributed to Cato), ⟨sacres⟩ (Varro *R.* . . , . .), and various *i*-stem forms in Sabellic (Osc. abl. sg. **sakrid**, U. acc. sg. **sakre**, etc.), although the vowel length in these forms is not directly attested.

On the background of **h₂óḱ-ri-*/**h₂éḱ-ri-* itself and the forms derived from it, see Nussbaum : .

On PIE vr̥ddhi (well-attested in Sanskrit and elsewhere), see Fortson : and Meier-Brügger : (the latter with additional references).

For a basic treatment, see Weiss : , ; on *sākri-*: Forssman : f.

An additional form of this type might be **mōl-i-* (Lat. *mōlēs* 'mass, e ort', cf. denominative *mōlior* 'strain, strive') vis-à-vis **mol-i-* (Gk. *μόλις* 'scarcely, with di culty' [trag.+], cf. **mol-* also in Lat. *molestus* 'annoying'); I hope to treat this material elsewhere.

This is in perfect accord with the standard pattern whereby adjectival renewals are based on the abstract that accompanied the original adjective; see Rau : f. (with examples).

(i.e., an *ācer*-type adjectival *i*-vr̥ddhi formation), and (ii) an adjective **rau̯i-ko-* 'hoarse' > *raucus* (§), formed with the su x **-ko-*, which is at the same time highly productive and also especially at home with descriptors of negative physical states and features (besides *raucus* 'hoarse', e.g. *plancus* 'flat-footed', *famēlicus* 'famished', etc.). The first of these, with its recessive vr̥ddhi formation, unsurprisingly did not survive as such; yet it served as the basis for the denominative hapax *rāviō* (conceivably even a nonce-form). The second—again predictably, given the productive nature of the formation—is the surviving adjectival renewal in this meaning. As an alternative to (i): perhaps the *ā*-vr̥ddhi outcome based on *răvi-* was a thematic adjective **rāvio-*, which then produced a denominative *rāviō/rāviāre* (of the type *nūntiāre*, § . (c, c′)).

4.4. Lat. *rāviō*, then, is a form with considerable linguistic interest, despite its neglect hitherto (apart from attempts to dismiss or eliminate it). First, and most obviously, the presumed basis **rāvi-* (according to the first option just proposed) may provide a new example of "*a* → *ā* *i*-vr̥ddhi", to add to the few existing forms like **sākri-* and **ākri-*; and the thematic alternative **rāvio-* would have its own interest as an "*a* → *ā* vr̥ddhi" example of a di erent sort. Moreover, in view of the background of **rāvi(o)-* as a derivative of an "*a*-grade" Thurneysen-Havet form (*răvi-*), itself based on an *o*-grade "*τομός* form" (§§ ,), the *ā*-vocalism of **rāvi(o)-*—and thus necessarily the "*a* → *ā* vr̥ddhi" process it incorporates—is incontrovertibly of Italic date. This is distinct (at least potentially) from both **sākri-* and **ākri-*: here, the age of the vr̥ddhi process is more di cult to specify, since both **sak-* (whether from PIE **sak-* or **sh₂k-*) and **ak-* (< PIE **h₂eḱ-*) could in principle be of Proto-Italic or even Late PIE date.

A second point of interest concerns the conjugation class of *rāviō*. The first option above operates with the assumption that an *i*-stem **rāvi-* should yield a th-conjugation denominative *rāviō/*rāvīre* (§ .)—for which, in fact, some support may be available in the gloss form *ravit* "rauie [i.e. *raucē*] loquitur" (*CGL* V. . , cf. Neue-Wagener :); yet the text of Festus (as abridged by Paul the Deacon) o ers ⟨ravias⟩, beside ⟨ravio⟩ (n.), and this might also be considered to support the alternative **rāvio-*, which can directly produce *rāviāre*. We may certainly, if we choose, disbelieve this testimony of Festus and/or Verrius Flaccus, whose accuracy in such matters was hardly perfect. But if the transmitted ⟨ravias⟩ is linguistically real (and if it carries more weight than the late gloss *ravit*), and if it is preferable to begin from an "*i*-vr̥ddhi"-form **rāvi-* (as it might be), we are led to consider whether a development **rāvi-* → *rāviāre* can be explained. This could be accomplished if we admit *rāviāre* as a precocious instance of the Late and Vulgar Latin type *levis* 'light' → *alleviāre* 'lighten' (Vulgate etc., cf. Fr. *alléger*), *mollis* 'soft' → *molliāre* 'soften' (*Notae Tironianae* and widespread in Romance), etc., whence eventually the productive Romance su x *-iāre* (e.g. **captiāre* > Fr. *chasser*, Ital. *cacciare*, etc.; Väänänen : f.). The formation was originally factitive (cf. *breviāre* 'shorten' [Quintil.+]), but then

See Fruyt on Lat. **-ko-* (especially f. on *raucus*).

lost this restriction, to judge from forms like *rabiāre* (V. . K and glosses, with the same meaning as *rabere* 'be raving mad'; Mignot : n.). Unfortunately, Fontaine's attempt (a: .) to support a Plautine instance of the *molliāre* type (*incomities*, *Cur.*) does not strike me as successful. But that does not mean that such forms could not have existed at that time in the spoken language.

In light of this proposal, it remains to comment briefly on the vulgarisms in Festus, recently studied by Lhommé ( ). As emerges from her analysis, those that are explicitly signaled (that is, with words such as "vulgus" or "vulgaris consuetudo") generally do not involve morphological material, but tend rather to refer to lexical substitutions (as compared to the standard language or other registers) or semantic distinctions. This does not, however, prevent Festus' "ravio, ravias" (n. : "[scil. antiqui] dicebant") from being a vulgarism: as Lhommé concludes (:), "Il y a sans doute de vrais vulgarismes chez Festus, tirés de Plaute ou de Lucilius, mais qui sont, eux, classés par Verrius sous la catégorie des mots des *antiqui*."

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If not for Fontaine's observation that Plautus generally does not pun on forms with di ering vowel length (cf. §), it may be tempting to consider whether *rāviō*, in context, may involve a pun on *rabiō* 'I'm going insane'.

Fontaine's analysis is complex, and a full refutation cannot be undertaken here; but among other problems: his suggestion is based on a word *incōmis* 'unkind' that is not otherwise attested until Florus (perhaps no earlier than the time of Trajan), and (much more damagingly) it crucially depends on a stem *incōmit-* (→ *incōmit-iāre*) with an alleged "iterative infix" that cannot be defended morphologically.

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